

What the end-users want

Acer talks to us about creating eco-friendly products and giving what their end-consumers want

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We spoke with the upper management over at Acer during their next@acer event to understand what drives the company towards making products for their consumers.

Q One of the interesting announcements you had was the whole Vero lineup of eco-friendly products. I noticed that you are putting in a lot of eco-friendly measures into creating the products, so you have the PCR (Post Consumer Recycled) plastic being used and you have VeroSense software. The other part of being eco-friendly is having some sort of logistical infrastructure to gather used laptops and recycle them. Do you have any such plans for countries when you serve the markets to have such logistics initiatives?

James K. Lin: We announced this product during our previous event and we're starting shipment in the Q3 time frame. From the material point of view, we need to come out with earth-friendly products. We see more and more products which, after disposal, cannot be recycled. With the help of a lot of our partners in the ecosystem, we are able to bring eco-friendly materials into our product designs. We know, given our vast experience, where the weak points lie in product design. We're able to use that knowledge to build complete PCR products. Whereas our competitors never did. They might have done so in some product lines but not in laptops.

In laptops, we're doing a lot of enhancements in the design. We've done a lot of structural enhancements as well.

We're not going to stop with just PCR. We'll continue working on new materials and as we explore more materials, we'll be able to create more products that are even more recyclable.

Q What's Acer's take on the global chip shortage? When do you see the crisis ending?

James K. Lin: Instead of calling it a shortage, we'd say that the demand for products is too strong. When the pandemic happened, we already had enough material supply but the demand was so strong that all the supply cannot catch up. Other industries also have high demands which only further compounded the issue for the PC industry. So it's hard to say when it will end.

Q When the Orion Desktop was showcased, we saw the Intel 12th Gen based Orion 7000 machines but we didn't see any AMD machines. Why is that?

Jeff J Lee: We have a full line-up of AMD products. Strategically, we worked with Intel on their 12th Gen platforms but we do think about AMD as well. From a performance consideration point of view, we do see a considerable performance jump from the previous generation to this generation, that's why we went with the 12th Gen platform.

Jerry Kao: Let me put it this way. This time we are selecting Intel but parallelly we are also working with AMD. I won't say that it is tradition for us to work with Intel only. Actually, both AMD and Intel are our very good partners. But you'll see one or the



Jerry Kao,
Co-Chief Operating Officer, President, IT Products Business

other at the front, if we respond to our end-users requirements. Whatever the end-user needs, we will provide that. Sometimes you'll see one and sometimes you'll see the other.

Q The ConceptD 7 SpatialLabs Edition was quite an interesting product and I can see how content creators might really put that feature to great use. During the presentation, you also mentioned gaming applications. How are you planning on integrating SpatialLabs in gaming applications?

Jane Hsu: The experience that we talked about is more about casual gaming such as web games. Because the 3D presented right now is all generated by AI. It analyses the scene and understands which elements need to be placed further back and also decides things like the main character should perhaps be closer to the user. It generates different depth-maps for the scene so that you can see it in 3D. It's all post processing even though you can see it all in 3D.

We're also thinking about how we can bring this to more serious gamers. We do see that there's a potential but it's just that we're now looking for an ecosystem. Such as the ConceptD 7 which is ready out-of-the-box with a bunch of useful applications, shortcuts for the software that creators are using, etc. If we can do that for gamers, then we would love to, it's just that we're still looking for ways to do that. **d**